



Fortnite shotguns nerfed

Epic Games announced that they will nerf shotguns, that often one-shot players, in Fortnite. <https://digit.in/jul18-63-1>



Rocket league meets...

Rocket League is getting a Jurassic World DLC pack which will contain two Jeep Wranglers. <https://digit.in/jul18-63-2>

The Red Zone has started

PUBG and Fortnite aren't the only games fighting it out anymore. Get ready for an overdose of battle royale games this year.

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ver since PlayerUnknown's Battlegrounds hit the big time last year, the Battle Royale genre has become a

staple in the gaming industry. Much like we had the MOBApocalypse prior to this, it looks like it is now the era of the Battle Royale with every game developer in a Battle Royale of their own to come up with the next PUBG, or should we say, the next Fortnite, which has surpassed PUBG to take the world by storm.

For the uninitiated, in the Battle royale game mode, 100 players land on a map to battle it out. They collect resources such as weapons, medical supplies and ammunition while staying inside a circular zone. Staying outside this circular zone means death and the zone keeps shrinking over intervals of time. It is a survival oriented mode, you collect the resources you need to stay alive. The last player or team standing wins. Fairly simply concept, heck, PUBG wasn't even the first to do it, that was a Minecraft mod. But hey, PUBG is what has made the genre big, and that's why we're here now, doing this rant. We've played PUBG, and we enjoyed it, for a while. Similarly, we

even played Fortnite and to be honest, while some of us are fans of the game mode, a few of us don't see the appeal.

As someone rightly put it, most Battle Royale games are just 95 per cent running simulator, four per cent hiding simulator and one per cent action. Boring! Despite that, these games have huge mass appeal. We get it though, genre preference and all that. Unfortunately, when other developers and publishers see numbers this big, they can't help but want a piece of



that Battle Royale \$\$\$\$. Which is why just about every other game release is either a Battle Royale game or has a dedicated Battle Royale game mode.

With every new iteration of the game mode we're seeing developers do crazy things in order to stand out from the two top dogs. This E3 we saw three new Battle Royale games being announced, and that was in addition to games such as The Darwin Project, Radical Heights, SCUM, etc., which are already on the way. Even mainstream AAA publishers are beginning to add dedicated Battle Royale game modes to their game, like Black Ops 4 is doing with their all-new "Blackout" game mode. We're getting that, but not a single-player campaign?! Are you serious? Some of us actually enjoy the Call of Duty single-player campaigns you know, despite how short they are.

As more and more Battle Royale games are announced for this year and the next, we'll eventually see which ones will stand the test of time. And then, we might finally see the genre reach saturation. We don't really have our hopes up for any of them. Except maybe the two current top dogs.

Thanks to the internet and things such as Twitch and YouTube, it's become significantly easier for things to go viral. Anything could go viral at the drop of a hat, at any given moment. This entire Battle Royale phase could be over tomorrow if some new game mode pops up all of a sudden and some huge Twitch streamer plays it. One can never tell.

Do you remember the deathmatch game mode? It used to be a highly popular game mode back in the day when Unreal Tournament and Quake



3 Arena were the undefeated kings. It is almost identical to the current situation, only on a much smaller scale. Over the years, we saw the deathmatch trickle down to pretty much every multiplayer FPS shooter game. Now nobody blinks an eye if a game releases with the deathmatch game mode available from launch. It's just expected to be there. We think the Battle Royale genre is also going down a similar route.

Meanwhile, for the current state of things, developers will continue pushing little updates with bubble guns and tricycles for transport. Or smaller maps to concentrate the play area because people are sick of mindlessly running across the map but there's hardly anymore scope left to introduce something game-changing to the genre. Maybe it's time to let it go?